

Kinect on PS3?

An Indian tech blogger is working on a project to integrate MS Kinect device with a Sony PS3 Console. Check out the video <http://bit.ly/i2G3uk>

Samsung's display plans

According to a Samsung projection, it will have tablets displays with 300 to 400 pixel-per-inch resolution by 2015

Graphics Card Dilemma



With vendors coming out with a new graphics card practically every week, Agent001 sets out to find out the card that will match your needs

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Graphics cards form part of a rapidly changing product category. Even though only AMD and NVIDIA come out with the main chipsets, there are numerous vendors who keep flooding the market with cards.

A trip to Lamington Road in Mumbai, is enough to overwhelm you with the different varieties of graphics card on offer. So to make matters simpler, I decided to go by the use-case scenarios. It is best to finalise on the chipset you will be needing and then based on the features offered, select the vendor brand. You will also come across cards that are overclocked out of the box.

To cover all the necessary categories in the limited space, with the pricing, I will not be getting into the technical specifications of the cards.

So let the proceedings begin.

HTPC enthusiast cards

Budget: Under ₹4,000

This category of cards is meant purely for providing the extra graphical boost to your system while viewing HD content or transcoding videos or using intensive applications like Photoshop or Maya. Do not fool yourself by expecting to game on these cards. You can get playable rates only if you keep the resolution under 1280x1024 pixels, with all the special effects disabled. Do not spend over ₹4,000 on this category of cards.

From the NVIDIA stable, you have the older generation GeForce 210 (around ₹2,100 to ₹3,000) or newer generation GeForce GT430 (which starts above ₹3,500). You also have AMD HD5450 (₹2,700 to ₹3,000) and the HD 4350 (₹2,000 to ₹3,000).

Mid Range cards

Budget: Between ₹5,000 to ₹10,000

This is where the majority of buying happens, according to my dealer friends at Lamington. Most buyers have a strict budget for gaming cards. And this category of cards offers you great playable rates are very economical pricing. You may not necessarily get a great performance if you crank up all your special effects, but it will allow you to game at a 1080p resolution with good playable frame rates.

The previous generation AMD HD 56xx (₹4,500 to ₹6,000) and 57xx (₹7,500 to ₹9,000) has a strong hold on this segment. NVIDIA has the GTS 450 (₹7,000 to ₹8,000). At the time of going to press NVIDIA had come out with GTX550Ti



Dual- GPU AMD Radeon HD 6990

need a good cooling solution if you are planning to get the GTX 4xx cards. Another interesting addition to this list has to be the GTX 560Ti which comes from ₹15,000 onwards.

Ultra High end Cards

Budget: Above ₹20,000

The fastest single GPU card right now is the NVIDIA GTX 580 followed closely by GTX 570. Both are based on the same architecture. AMD's HD6970 does not perform as well but sells around the same price as the GTX 570. The older generation HD58xx series card also fall in this segment. The dual-GPU solution from AMD - the HD 6990 was launched last month is claimed to be faster than its previous generation HD5970. But at the time of going to press, NVIDIA was about to take the lid off its flagship card, most probably the GTX 590, so the battle for the fastest dual-GPU card is still on.

Price wise, the reference GTX 580 retails around ₹30,000 and comes in a range of variants including the overclocked versions. The GTX 570 comes between ₹21,000 to ₹28,000. Radeon HD6970 sells for anywhere between ₹22,000 to ₹27,000 depending upon the configuration. The dual-GPU flagship card from AMD is priced around a whopping ₹50,000.

So next time you go graphic card shopping, do follow this method of pinning down your required graphics chipset and then going in for the kill – the vendor selling the card. **d**



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(pricing around ₹9,000 to ₹10,000). So do wait for its reviews before plunging in to buy a card in this category.

High end Cards

Budget: Between ₹10,000 to ₹20,000

In this price bracket, you should expect cards that will allow excellent gaming on cranking up the special effects like Anisotropic filtering or Anti-Aliasing. Chipsets to be considered from NVIDIA are GTX 460, GTX 465, GTX 470 whereas from AMD, HD6850, HD6870, HD5850 provide the most bang for the buck. But the GTX 470 and GTX 480 consume comparatively more power and generate more heat than the HD68xx cards, so you may